Ecotopia: Game Activities, Quests & Gameplay Guide

Comprehensive Game Design, Activity Roster & Quest Mechanics
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> **Target Audience & Document Scope:**
> This guide is the master operating reference for **Wout (Game Design)**, **Activity Coordinators**, **Volunteer Game Creators**, and **Quest Writers**.
> It consolidates the entire core gameplay loop, the carbon credit economy, the 10-ministry faction rivalries, the brainstormed activity catalog, quest structures, and the revolution endgame sequence.

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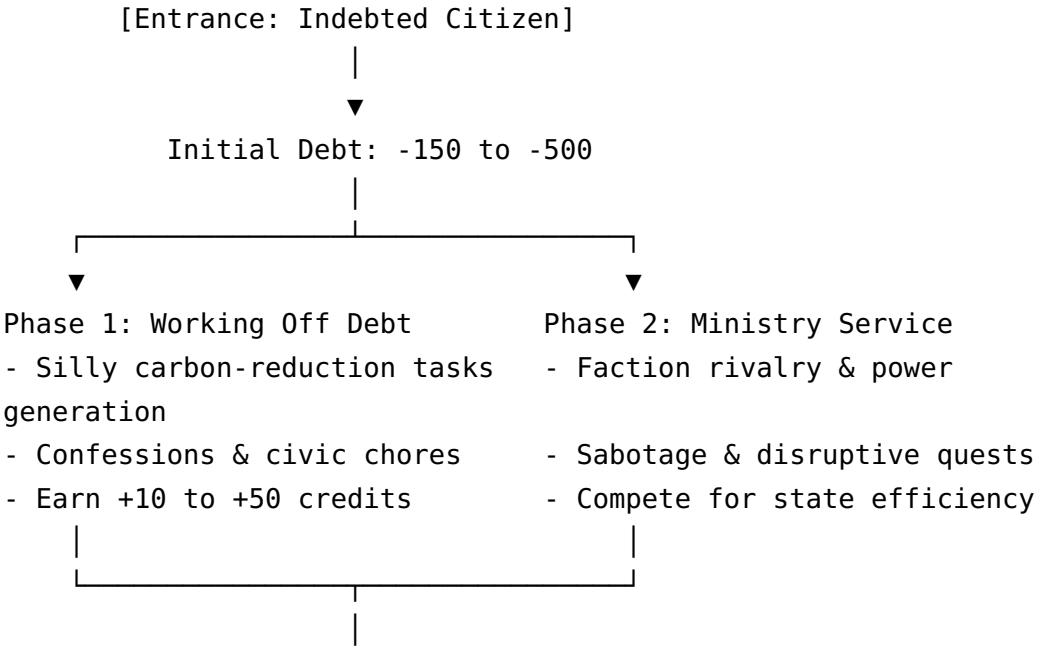
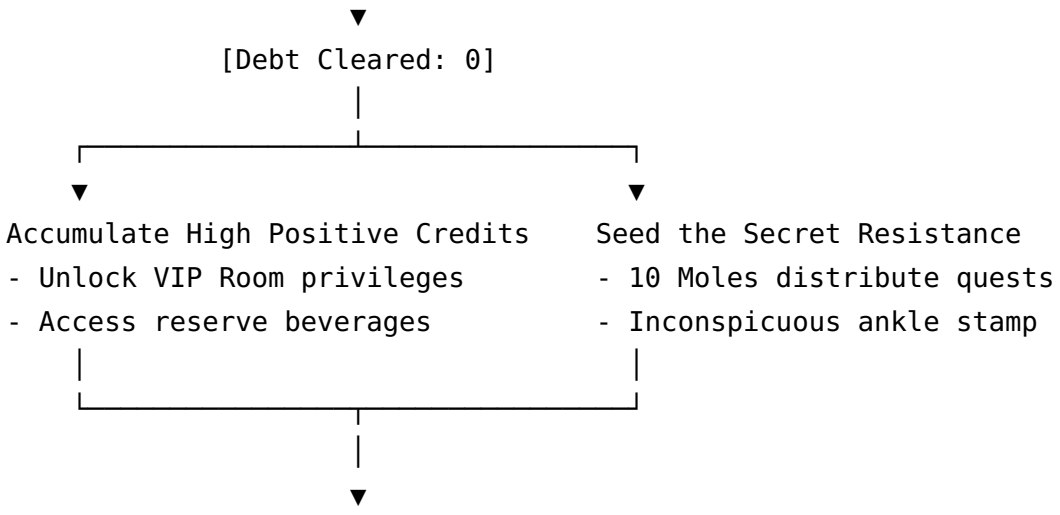
1. The Core Gameplay Loop

The interactive game runs for approximately **2 to 2.5 hours** (typically 21:30 to 00:00) before transitioning into the open dance party.





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2. The Economy: Carbon Credits & Passports

Single Currency Mechanic

There is only one currency in Ecotopia: **Carbon Credits**. * **Born into Debt:** Every guest starts with a **negative balance** stamped into their physical booklet (calculated during intake: base `-100` plus confession penalties = `-150` to `-500`). * **Direction of Travel:** All gameplay moves this number upward toward zero, and then into positive territory. * **Why Being Sustainable Gives You Power:** Accumulating high positive credits grants bureaucratic authority, VIP perks, and room access. The game intentionally never explains why high sustainability equates to political power—that moral disorientation is the core satire.

Thresholds & Privileges

- **Negative Balance (`< 0`):** Restricted to indentured labor tasks and baseline civic zones.
- **Zero Balance (`0`):** Full Citizen status unlocked; guest can fully represent and score points for their assigned Ministry.
- **Privilege Tier (`+100` and above):** Access to the **VIP Room** (The Library) serving high-end reserve scotch, reserved exclusively for the ruling party's "elite servants."
- **Single & Family Status Bonuses:**
  - Self-declared singles receive a bonus credit bump (*"not contributing to biological overpopulation"*).
  - Guests reporting children receive an additional debt penalty.

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3. The 10 Factions: Inter-Ministry Rivalry

Guests (~200 total) are divided evenly into **10 Newspeak Ministries** (~20 citizens per ministry). Each ministry has distinct ideological mandates and competing priorities:

Newspeak Ministry	Domain & Focus	Dilemma & Source of Friction
Miniplenty	Caloric distribution & rations	Must cut fellow citizens' portions to meet zero-waste quotas.
Minilove	Surveillance & behavioral audits	Must interrogate other guests and investigate suspected heresy.
Minijoy	Mandatory cheer & morale testing	Must police grief, eradicate nostalgia, and force celebrations.
Minirenewal	Upcycling & citizen recycling	Runs the recycling booth; seeks candidates for identity erasure.
Minilight	Kilowatt rationing & power generation	Must plunge rooms into blackouts or force guests onto generator bikes.
Miniflow	Water metering & fluid recovery	Audits beverage cups, bathroom usage (*Peetopia*), and spills.
Minibreath	Atmospheric quotas & lung control	Meters exhalations; penalizes hyperventilation and sighing.
Minishelter	Confinement & 15-minute grids	Enforces room curfews and manages corridor congestion.
Miniservice		

Newspeak Ministry	Domain & Focus	Dilemma & Source of Friction
	Physical labor squads & chores	Conscripts idle citizens into scullery work and greenwashing.
Minithrift	Confiscation of private property	Seizes unauthorized luxury items and synthetic petroleum goods.

Live Hourly Rule Escalations

Roughly once every 45–60 minutes, the ruling regime escalates state restrictions over the PA system. Each escalation introduces a new absurd rule that ministries must enforce or navigate (e.g., *"By decree of Minilight, all ambient lumens are reduced by 40%. Any citizen caught lingering near light sources must perform 20 squats"*).

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4. Master Games & Activities Catalog

Activity creators and volunteer facilitators should select, run, and adapt games from this approved working catalog.

Category A: Fast Kinetic & Party Games

- **Wig Snatching:** Two participants wearing identical synthetic wigs face off in a duel to snatch the other's wig. *Framing:* The wig represents unauthorized "individualistic thought" or "free vanity" being purged. Fast, fun, and easy to run as an elimination tournament.
- **Lights Off Stealth:** Minilight wardens and citizens attempt to turn off room switches to conserve grid wattage, while rebels try to keep the lights on without getting caught.
- **Stationary Power Bicycle (Kinetic Grid):** A rigged bicycle generator powering a bulb or sound feed. Indebted citizens must pedal for 5-minute shifts to earn +30 credits toward clearing their debt.

Category B: Performance & Ideological Competitions

- **How the World Ends:** A dramatic open-mic competition. Guests compete to deliver the most theatrical, melodramatic 60-second retelling of human ecological extinction (via monologue, song, or operatic cry). Judged by Minijoy wardens.
- **Ministry Rally & Gesture Speech:** On a mini-podium with banners and microphone, citizens deliver a passionate 90-second propaganda speech advocating their ministry's harsh doctrine, complete with a signature state salute or hand gesture.
- **Sound Guessing:** A blindfolded or turned citizen listens to three people behind them making animal or ecological distress sounds (*"a dehydrated bear," "the last bumblebee in Europe," "a caged zoo animal"*). The guesser must identify the species and perpetrator.
- **Policy Infiltration (Telephone Sabotage):** A whisper-down-the-line game where an agent must infiltrate a rival ministry, learn their core policy, and corrupt it before whispering it back to the state stenographer.

Category C: Civic Chores & Absurd Labor ("Greenwashing")

- **Greenwashing the Dishes:** Indebted citizens report to the scullery station to scrub glassware or prep materials using strict water-conservation rules (e.g., single-sponge wiping). Clears +25 credits per shift.
- **Recycled Glasses Audit:** Bar and cleanup volunteers walk the floor asking guests: *"Has this glass completed its circular transit?"* Guests must justify their beverage vessel efficiency.
- **Confession Booth:** A dimly lit cubicle where citizens confess the worst environmental crime of their old-world past to a stony-faced Minilove auditor.
- **Peetopia (Sacred Fluid Balance):** Miniflow monitoring station outside the restrooms. Citizens returning biological fluid to the collective facility receive a credit stamp for returning moisture to the state.

Category D: Re-Education & The Recycling Plant

- **Minirenewal Recycling Booth ("The Suicide Carbon Booth"):**
  - For citizens who accumulate too many heresy strikes, wish to defect from a despised ministry, or have unpayable carbon debt.

    - The guest enters the booth, undergoes an absurd theatrical ritual (composting oath, face paint, or shedding their outer layer).
    - *Outcome:* Their old identity is struck from the record; their carbon debt is reset to exactly `0`; they are given a new citizen number and redeployed into a new ministry.

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5. Quests & Resistance Mechanics

1. Quest Architecture

Every citizen receives personal quests alongside their collective ministry duties: 1. **Civic Duty Quests (Standard):** Tasks that enforce ministry rules on others (e.g., *"Convince 3 citizens from Miniplenty to surrender their snack tickets"* or *"Plant an efficiency sticker on a Miniservice officer without being spotted"*). 2. **Cross-Disruptive Quests (Friction):** Quests pitting ministries against one another to generate comedic bureaucratic gridlock.

2. The Secret Resistance Track

- **The 10 Moles:** At check-in, 10 unsuspecting guests receive special discrete quests directing them toward subtle clues (hidden in the recycling booth, bathroom mirrors, or bar conversations).
- **Headquarters:** Hidden in **Thijs's room** behind an unassuming door.
- **The Ankle Stamp:** Resistance membership spreads virally through a physical rubber stamp passed hand-to-hand. To join, an existing member must stamp your ankle. The mark remains invisible under trousers/socks until inspected.

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6. Climax & Endgame: The Revolution (23:30 – 00:15)

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23:30 ── State Assembly: Leader's Grand Spectacle & Ministry Showcases
23:45 ── Resistance Raid: Ankle-stamped rebels storm the podium
00:00 ── The Great Reveal: Cellar server node exposed; compliance proved a sham
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`00:15 ── Transition: The system falls; DJs take over for the dance party`

1. **The State Assembly (23:30):** The loudspeaker orders all 10 Ministries to gather before the main stage. The supreme figurehead arrives amidst smoke and fanfare. Each ministry must present their chant, anthem, or synchronized formation.
2. **The Resistance Raid (23:45):** Once the resistance has recruited over 50% of the party via ankle stamps, the moles signal the revolt. The resistance interrupts the ceremonies, chanting anti-bureaucratic slogans.
3. **The Big Reveal (00:00):** The revolutionaries unveil the secret evidence: the entire carbon credit ledger, the surveillance cameras, and the Guardian Stag calculations were never ecological—they were running on a salvaged corporate AI server node in the cellar! The regime was simply running compliance theater to preserve power.
4. **Resolution (00:15):** The ministries dissolve their rivalries, citizens tear out their passport debt pages, and the stage converts immediately into a celebration dance floor with DJs running until 04:00+.

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7. Guidelines for Activity Creators (`/creators`)

When building a game or side quest for Ecotopia, follow these core principles: 1. **Always Word Positively:** Punishments are *“privileges”*; starvation is *“caloric purity”*; forced chores are *“joyful civic service.”* 2. **Keep the Barrier to Entry Low:** Games must take under 3 minutes to learn and under 10 minutes to play. 3. **Always Award Credit Stamps:** Every completed activity must offer a tangible reward on the player’s physical passport booklet (+10 to +50 credits). 4. **Respect the Universal Safe-Word:** If any player utters **“OZONE”**, pause immediately, drop character, and ensure they are supported.